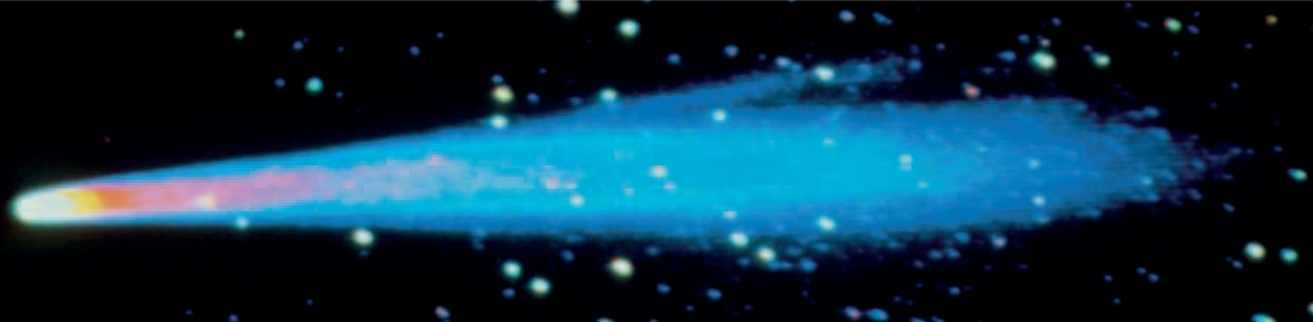




This modern photograph shows Halley's Comet, named after the British astronomer Edmond Halley, who was the first to determine that the comet returned periodically, every 76 years.

THE BATTLE OF BLENHEIM, fought in 1704 near the village of Blindheim on the Danube in Bavaria, Germany, ended in victory for the Duke of Marlborough and the Grand Alliance (see 1701), and turned the **War of the Spanish Succession** in favor of the Grand Alliance. The battle halted a Franco-Bavarian march on Vienna, and Bavaria played no further part in the war.

Meanwhile, the **Gibraltar peninsula** on the Spanish mainland was seized by a combined Dutch-English force in 1704; Gibraltar was ceded perpetually to Britain in 1713.

Victor of Blenheim

The Duke of Marlborough (in red) sits astride his horse in this tapestry, now hanging in his eventual home, Blenheim Palace, England.



300 THE NUMBER OF POCUMTUCKS AMONG THE RAIDERS AT DEERFIELD

In Tunisia to the southeast, the **Husaynid dynasty** was established in 1705 when Al-Husayn ibn 'Ali (1669–1740) was recognized by the Ottoman sultan as governor of the province. The Husaynid dynasty lasted until Tunisia gained independence in 1957.

In North America, **Deerfield, Massachusetts**, was the scene in 1704 of a massacre of English colonists by a combined force



News from home

Published weekly, The Boston News-Letter provided English colonists in America with news of England's political events and wars.

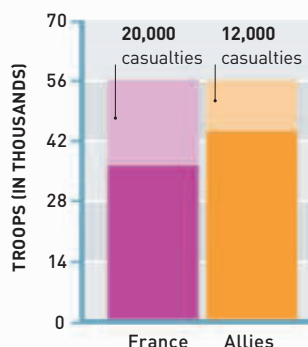
of French-Canadians and American Indians. Also in 1704, **The Boston News-Letter**, North America's first continuously published newspaper, appeared, largely funded by the British government.

In 1706, the most decisive event in the War of the Spanish Succession occurred in North Italy, where the Duke of Savoy, allied with Austria and Britain, was defending his territory against French invasion and siege of the capital, Turin. The French were crushed when the Duke of Savoy and Prince Eugene broke through French lines and routed the army, driving them out of North Italy.

Also in 1706, Spanish conquistador **Juan de Uribarri** claimed southeastern Colorado, an area populated by warring American Indian tribes, and joined it to **Spanish New Mexico**.

In England, the **first steam engine** using moving parts was built in 1704 by **Thomas Newcomen** (1663–1729) and Thomas Savery (see 1698). The first working Newcomen engine was installed to pump water from a mine in Staffordshire in 1712.

Edmond Halley (1656–1742), English mathematician and astronomer, published *A Synopsis of the Astronomy of Comets* in 1705, in which he described the parabolic orbits of 24 comets. He proved that three sightings, many decades apart, were of a single comet—the comet that is now known as Halley's Comet—and determined that this comet returns to the solar system every 76 years.



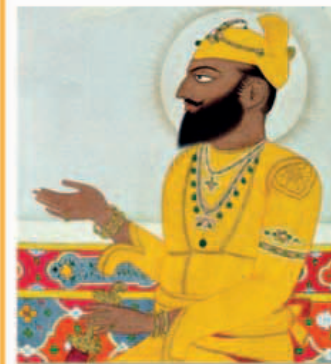
Battle of Blenheim losses

About 112,000 troops took part in the Battle of Blenheim, with 20,000 French casualties but almost half as many from Britain and its allies.



This picture depicts the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb hunting nilgai.

THE DEATH IN 1707 OF AURANGZEB, sixth Mughal emperor of India (b. 1618), marked the start of the decline of the Mughal Empire. Aurangzeb's successors squandered the dynasty's fortunes while losing control of regional governors, who went on to build their own empires. Aurangzeb, disturbed by the growing power of the **Sikh Guru Gobind Singh**, had



GURU GOBIND SINGH
(1666–1708)

The tenth and last guru of Sikhism, Gobind Singh was a powerful figure in Indian history. In 1699 he transformed Sikhism by creating the Khalsa (Pure), a community of the faith that trained as warriors; now the Khalsa embraces all Sikhs. Aurangzeb considered coming to terms with Gobind Singh, but the rajas of the Sivalik Hills remained hostile, and Gobind Singh was assassinated in 1708.

February 29, 1704 English colonists in Massachusetts massacred and Deerfield sacked

August 13, 1704 Grand Alliance and Franco-Bavarian troops fight Battle of Blenheim

1704 British inventors Thomas Newcomen and Thomas Savery build first steam engine with moving parts

1705 British astronomer Edmond Halley publishes *A Synopsis of the Astronomy of Comets*

November 1705 Capitol building completed in Williamsburg, capital of English colony of Virginia

January 17, 1706 A future founder of the US, Benjamin Franklin, is born (d. 1790)

September 7, 1706 French defeated by Austrian and Savoyard forces in Battle of Turin

1706 Southeastern Colorado claimed by Spanish New Mexico

March 17, 1707 Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb (b. 1618) dies

April 25, 1707 Defeat of Grand Alliance at Almanza, Spain

May 1, 1707 Acts of Union come into effect, uniting Scotland and England